

possible to end up in a deadlock situation in C++, if we cannot acquire all the locks in a single call to `std::lock` due to application design issues, since we may need to acquire the locks in different points in the program. Hence the responsibility of avoiding the deadlocks is placed on the programmer. While `std::lock_guard` and `std::lock` cover most of the basic functionality needed for ensuring that shared data is protected, C++11 also offers certain additional functionality. One of them is `std::unique_lock` which will cover in next month's column.

My 'must-read book' for this month

This month's suggestion for a must-read book comes from one of our readers, Raghuram, who recommended 'Patterns for Parallel Programming' by Timothy G Mattson, Beverly A Sanders and Berna L Massingill, published by Addison Wesley. As Raghuram says, "This book gives an excellent overview of the various techniques used for writing effective parallel code. The authors cover Java, OpenMP and MPI as the three parallel programming paradigms while explaining the parallel patterns. They also explain in detail lots of parallel programming

jargon such as CC-NUMA, SPMD, 'Explicitly Parallel' and so on." Thank you, Raghuram, for the recommendation.

If you have a favourite programming book/article that you think is a must-read for every programmer, please do send me a note with the book's name, and a short write-up on why you think it is useful so I can mention it in this column. This would help many readers who want to improve their coding skills.

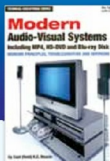
If you have any favourite programming puzzles that you would like to discuss on this forum, please send them to me, along with your solutions and feedback, at sandyasm_AT_yahoo_DOT_com. Till we meet again next month, happy programming and here's wishing you the very best! 

By: Sandya Mannarswamy

The author is an expert in systems software and works at Hewlett-Packard India. Her interests include compilers, multi-core technologies and software development tools. If you are preparing for systems software interviews, you may find it useful to visit Sandya's Linked In group *Computer Science Interview Training India* at <http://www.linkedin.com/groups?home=&gid=2339182>.

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